

Word family: **centre / centres / centred / centring / central / centrally / centrality / centrepiece**

Base word: centre

American spelling: center

Plural: centres

Past tense: centred

Past participle: centred

Related forms: central, centrally, centrality

Useful extensions: centrepiece, city centre, shopping centre, rescue centre, centre of attention, centre on, be centred on

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related adjective and adverb family (相關形容詞及副詞)

Your sentence:

> “One minute, the living room becomes a space station, and the next it turns into a jungle, a castle, or even a rescue **centre**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **centre** means:

> **a place or organization where a particular activity, service, or type of work is carried out**

A **rescue centre** is therefore a place where rescue-related work, care, coordination, or assistance happens.

繁體中文： **中心**；專門進行某類活動、提供某種服務或處理某項工作的地方 / 機構**

中文翻譯：

> “The living room ... turns into ... a rescue centre.”

「客廳.....甚至會變成一個**救援中心**。」

Here:

centre = 專門為某種特定活動或服務而設的地方 / 機構

1. **centre = place for a particular activity/service (中心) — 中心；機構**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The living room ... turns into ... a rescue **centre**.”

「客廳.....甚至會變成一個**救援中心**。」

Practice 2

> “The town has a new sports **centre**.”

「鎮上有一個新的**體育中心**。」

Practice 3

> “She works at a community **centre**.”

「她在一間**社區中心**工作。」

centre = 專門進行某類活動、提供某種服務或集中某項工作的地方 / 機構

2. **shopping centre** (購物中心) — 商場 ; 購物中心

Practice 4

> “There is a large shopping **centre** nearby.”

「附近有一個大型**購物中心 / 商場**。」

Practice 5

> “We spent the afternoon at the shopping **centre**.”

「我們下午都在**商場**。」

shopping centre = 集中多間商店、餐飲及其他服務的商業設施

3. **community centre** (社區中心) — 社區中心

Practice 6

> “The classes are held at the community **centre**.”

「課程在**社區中心**舉行。」

Practice 7

> “The community **centre** offers activities for children.”

「**社區中心**為小朋友提供活動。」

community centre = 為本地居民提供活動、服務和公共空間的地方

4. **medical / health centre** (醫療中心) — 醫療中心；診所中心

Practice 8

> “She went to the health **centre**.”

「她去了**醫療中心**。」

Practice 9

> “The new medical **centre** opened last month.”

「新的**醫療中心**上個月啟用。」

centre = 專門提供某類醫療、健康或專業服務的設施

5. **centre** = middle point (中央 / 中心點) — 中心；正中央

A major literal meaning.

Practice 10

> “Put the table in the **centre** of the room.”

「把桌子放在房間的**中央**。」

Practice 11

> “There is a fountain in the **centre** of the square.”

「廣場**中央**有一個噴泉。」

centre = 某個範圍、物件或空間中距離各邊大致相等的中央位置

6. **centre of a circle (圓心) — 中心點 ; 圓心**

Practice 12

> “Mark the **centre** of the circle.”

「標出圓的**圓心**。」

Practice 13

> “Draw a line through the **centre**.”

「畫一條穿過**中心點**的線。」

centre = 幾何圖形中具有特定中央位置的點

7. **centre = central area of a town/city (市中心) — 市中心 ; 中心地區**

A major geographic meaning.

Practice 14

> “She lives near the city **centre**.”

「她住在**市中心**附近。」

Practice 15

> “The hotel is in the town **centre**.”

「酒店位於**鎮中心**。」

city/town centre = 城市或城鎮中商業、交通、行政等較集中的中央地區

BrE:

> city centre

AmE often prefers:

> downtown

8. **centre = main focus of activity (活動中心 / 核心地區) — 中心 ; 重地**

A figurative/geographic extension.

Practice 16

> “The city became a **centre** of trade.”

「這座城市成為一個貿易**中心**。」

Practice 17

> “The region is an important **centre** for technology.”

「這個地區是重要的科技**中心**。」

centre = 某類活動、產業、文化或影響力高度集中的地方

9. **centre = most important point/focus (核心) — 核心 ; 焦點**

A major abstract meaning.

Practice 18

> “Education is at the **centre** of the debate.”

「教育是這場討論的**核心**。」

Practice 19

> “Family is at the **centre** of her life.”

「家庭是她生活的**核心**。」

centre = 某件事中最重要、最核心或最受關注的部分

10. **at the centre of something (處於核心) — 位於……核心 ; 是……焦點**

Practice 20

> “She is at the **centre of** the project.”

「她是這個項目的**核心人物**。」

Practice 21

> “The issue is at the **centre of** public discussion.”

「這個議題正處於公共討論的**核心**。」

at the centre of X = 在某件事中處於最重要、最核心或最受關注的位置

11. **centre of attention** (注意力焦點) — 焦點；眾人注目的中心

Practice 22

> “He loves being the **centre of attention**.”

「他很喜歡成為**眾人注目的焦點**。」

Practice 23

> “The child suddenly became the **centre of attention**.”

「那個小朋友突然成為大家注意的**焦點**。」

centre of attention = 最受別人注意、目光或關注的人 / 事物

12. **centre** = ideological/political middle (中間立場) — 中間派；中間立場

A distinct abstract meaning.

Practice 24

> “The party moved closer to the political **centre**.”

「該政黨的立場向政治**中間派**靠近。」

Practice 25

> “His views are generally in the **centre**.”

「他的觀點大致屬於**中間立場**。」

****centre = 在政治、思想或立場光譜中介乎兩端之間的位置****

This is a genuine domain-specific meaning.

13. ****centre — verb = put something in the middle (置中) — 置於中央；使居中****

Now ****centre**** functions as a verb.

Practice 26

> “****Centre**** the picture on the wall.”

「把圖片**放在牆的正中央**。」

Practice 27

> “The title should be ****centred****.”

「標題應該**置中**。」

****centre something = 把某物放在中央位置****

14. ****centre on / centre around (以……為中心) — 圍繞；集中於****

A major abstract verb use.

Practice 28

> “The discussion ****centred on**** education.”

「討論**圍繞教育問題**展開。」

Practice 29

> “The story ****centres around**** a young family.”

「故事**圍繞一個年輕家庭**展開。」

****centre on/around X = 把主要注意力、內容或活動集中在某個主題 / 人物上****

Usage note:

- > **centre on** is often considered more precise in formal writing.
- > **centre around** is extremely common in everyday modern English.

15. **be centred on (以.....為核心) — 以.....為中心 ; 建基於**

Practice 30

- > “The programme is **centred on** children’s needs.”

「這個計劃**以兒童的需要為核心**。」

Practice 31

- > “The course is **centred on** practical skills.”

「這個課程**以實用技能為重點**。」

be centred on X = 以某件事作為主要焦點、組織核心或設計基礎

16. **centre yourself (使自己恢復平靜 / 集中) — 讓自己鎮定 ; 找回重心**

A figurative psychological use.

Practice 32

- > “She took a deep breath to **centre herself**.”

「她深呼吸，讓自己**平靜下來、重新集中精神**。」

Practice 33

- > “Meditation helps him **centre himself**.”

「冥想幫助他**找回內在平衡**。」

centre yourself = 使自己的注意力、情緒或心理狀態重新平穩和集中

This is more common in wellness/psychological language.

17. **central = in the middle (中央的) — 中央的 ; 中心的**

The main adjective form.

Practice 34

> “The hotel has a **central** location.”

「酒店的位置非常**中心 / 便利**。」

Practice 35

> “The building has a **central** courtyard.”

「大樓中央有一個**中庭**。」

central = 位於某個地方的中央或接近中心位置的

18. **central = most important (核心的) — 核心的 ; 主要的**

A major figurative adjective meaning.

Practice 36

> “Trust is **central** to a good relationship.”

「信任對良好關係來說是**核心因素**。」

Practice 37

> “Family plays a **central** role in her life.”

「家庭在她生活中扮演**核心角色**。」

central = 對某事物極為重要、處於核心位置的

19. **central to + noun (對.....至關重要) — 對.....核心 / 重要**

Practice 38

> “Creativity is **central** to Leo’s personality.”

「創意是 Leo 性格中的**核心特質**。」

Practice 39

> “Communication is **central** to teamwork.”

「溝通對團隊合作**至關重要**。」

central to X = 是 X 的核心組成部分，對其運作 / 存在非常重要

20. **central** = relating to a main governing/control body (中央的) — 中央的；總部性的

Practice 40

> “The decision was made by the **central** government.”

「這個決定由**中央政府**作出。」

Practice 41

> “The company has a **central** office.”

「公司有一個**中央 / 總部辦公室**。」

central = 屬於主要管理、控制或協調機構的

21. **centrally** = in/from the centre (中央地 / 集中地) — 位於中心地；集中地

Practice 42

> “The hotel is **centrally located**.”

「酒店**位處市中心 / 位置便利**。」

Practice 43

> “The data is stored **centrally**.”

「資料被**集中儲存**。」

****centrally = 在中央位置；或由一個主要中心統一管理 / 處理****

22. ****centrality = importance/central position (核心性) — 核心地位；重要性****

A formal academic noun.

Practice 44

> “The study emphasizes the ****centrality**** of family relationships.”

「研究強調家庭關係的****核心重要性****。」

Practice 45

> “The city’s ****centrality**** made it an important trading hub.”

「這座城市的****中心位置****令它成為重要貿易樞紐。」

****centrality = 位於中心的狀態，或某事物具有核心重要性的程度****

Register:

> formal / academic

23. ****centrepiece = central decorative object (中心裝飾) — 中央擺設；中心裝飾品****

A useful lexical extension.

Practice 46

> “Flowers formed the ****centrepiece**** of the table.”

「鮮花成為桌子的****中心裝飾****。」

Practice 47

> “The cake was the ****centrepiece**** of the display.”

「蛋糕是展示區的****中心焦點****。」

****centrepiece = 放在中央、最引人注目或作為主要焦點的物件****

American spelling:

> **centerpiece**

24. **centrepiece** = most important feature (核心項目) — 核心 ; 重點

A figurative extension.

Practice 48

> “Education is the **centrepiece** of the plan.”

「教育是這個計劃的**核心項目**。」

Practice 49

> “The new park is the **centrepiece** of the redevelopment.”

「新公園是這次重建計劃的**核心項目**。」

centrepiece = 一個計劃、活動或安排中最突出、最重要的部分

Important distinction: **centre vs middle**

centre

often means:

> the precise or conceptual central point.

middle

means:

> the area between two ends/sides.

Compare:

> “the centre of the circle”

= 圓心

> “the middle of the road”

= 馬路中間

They often overlap, but **centre** can sound more exact.

Important distinction: **centre vs **heart****

Both can be figurative.

**centre**

emphasizes:

> central position / main focus.

**heart**

often adds:

> emotional, vital, or essential importance.

> “the centre of the city”

= 市中心

> “the heart of the city”

= 城市核心地帶，常帶文化 / 活力意味

Important distinction: **centre vs **core****

**centre**

can be spatial or abstract.

**core**

usually emphasizes:

> deepest, most essential part.

> “at the centre of the debate”

= 討論焦點

> “the core problem”

= 最根本的問題

They overlap, but **core** often feels more conceptual/essential.

Important distinction: **centre vs hub**

centre

is broad.

hub

strongly suggests:

> a place where many activities, connections, routes, or people come together.

> “a technology hub”

= 科技樞紐

> “a technology centre”

= 科技中心

Hub highlights connectivity.

Important distinction: **centre vs station**

This is directly useful after the previous word.

station

often emphasizes:

> a fixed operational post where staff/equipment are based.

****centre****

often emphasizes:

> a place where a broader set of services, activities, care, or coordination is concentrated.

Compare:

> ****rescue station****

> = 救援人員 / 設備駐守基地

> ****rescue centre****

> = 救援、協調、接收、照顧等活動集中的中心

They can overlap, but the emphasis differs.

Important distinction: ****centre vs facility****

****facility****

= a building/site/equipment provided for a particular purpose.

****centre****

often implies:

> that the activity/service is organized or concentrated there.

A centre is often a facility, but ****facility**** is broader and more technical.

Important distinction: ****centre vs headquarters****

****centre****

= activity/service hub.

****headquarters****

= main administrative command location of an organization.

A rescue centre is not necessarily the headquarters of the rescue organization.

Important distinction: **centre — physical middle vs centre — institutional place**

Physical:

> “Stand in the centre of the room.”

= 站在房間中央。

Institutional:

> “She works at a health centre.”

= 她在醫療中心工作。

These are genuinely distinct learner-relevant meanings.

Important distinction: **centre of attention vs centre of a room**

Spatial:

> “the centre of the room”

= 房間中央

Figurative:

> “the centre of attention”

= 注意力焦點

The figurative branch maps:

> physical central position → social/mental focus.

Important distinction: **centre on vs focus on**

These are very close.

centre on

= have as the main subject/core.

focus on

= direct attention specifically toward.

> “The book centres on family relationships.”

describes what the book is fundamentally about.

> “The chapter focuses on family relationships.”

describes where attention is directed.

Important distinction: **centre on vs centre around**

Both are common.

centre on

often preferred in formal/edited English because the metaphor is:

> something has a centre **on** a point.

centre around

very common in actual modern speech and writing.

For learner production, **centre on** is the cleaner formal choice.

Important distinction: **central vs centre**

centre

noun:

> “the centre of the city”

central

adjective:

> “a central location”

So:

> centre = 中心

> central = 中央的 / 核心的

Important distinction: **central = middle vs central = important**

Spatial:

> “a central location”

= 中央位置

Figurative:

> “a central issue”

= 核心問題

The same adjective moves naturally from physical centrality to importance.

Important distinction: **central vs main**

main

= most important/principal.

central

= fundamental to the structure, argument, or function.

> “the main reason”

= 最主要原因

> “a central principle”

= 核心原則

They often overlap, but **central** emphasizes structural/core importance.

Important distinction: **centrepiece vs centre**

centre

= physical/functional middle or hub.

centrepiece

= the particular object/feature intended to be the visual or conceptual focal point.

A table has a **centre**, but the flowers placed there may be the **centrepiece**.

Important distinction: **British centre vs American center**

Spelling difference:

British/Commonwealth English

> **centre**

> centred

> centring

American English

> **center**

> centered

> centering

Your passage uses:

> **centre**

which matches British-style spelling.

The meanings are the same.

Family-extension note

Centre is a strong moderate polysemy word built around the concept:

> **a central point where position, activity, attention, or importance is concentrated**

The main learner-relevant branches are:

- * **physical middle**
- * **institution/service centre**
- * **city/town centre**
- * **activity/industry centre**
- * **abstract focus/core**
- * **political middle**
- * **verb: place in middle**
- * **verb: centre on a topic**

The family sweep adds:

- * **central**
- * **centrally**
- * **centrality**
- * **centrepiece**

Many compounds—**shopping centre, medical centre, rescue centre, community centre**—share the same institutional “place where an activity/service is concentrated” meaning and should not be artificially split into separate lexical senses just because Chinese translations differ. That follows the manual’s core rule that domain or translation differences alone do not create new meanings.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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centre — activity/service place	專門進行某類活動、提供某種服務或集中某項工作的地方 / 機構
shopping centre	集中多間商店和服務的購物設施 / 商場
community centre	為本地居民提供活動、服務和公共空間的場所
medical/health centre	集中提供醫療 / 健康服務的設施
centre — physical middle	某個範圍或物件中距離各邊大致相等的中央位置
centre — geometry	幾何圖形中的中央基準點
city/town centre	城市 / 城鎮中商業、交通、行政等較集中的中央地區
centre — activity hub	某種產業、文化或活動高度集中的地方
centre — core/focus	某事中最重要、最核心或最受關注的部分
at the centre of	在某事中處於核心 / 焦點位置
centre of attention	最受眾人注意的人 / 事物
centre — political	思想 / 政治光譜中介乎兩端之間的中間立場
centre — verb, physical	把某物放在中央位置

centre on/around	把主要內容、活動或注意力集中在某主題 / 人物上	
be centred on	以某事作為主要焦點或組織核心	
centre yourself	令自己重新平靜、集中或取得心理平衡	
central — spatial	位於中央或接近中心位置的	
central — figurative	對某事非常重要、處於核心地位的	
central to	是某事的核心組成部分，對其極為重要	
central — organizational	屬於主要管理 / 控制機構的	
centrally	在中央位置，或由主要中心統一管理	
centrality	位於中心的狀態，或具有核心重要性的程度	
centrepiece — physical	放在中央、作為主要視覺焦點的物件	
centrepiece — figurative	計劃、活動或安排中最突出、最重要的核心部分	

For your original sentence

> “One minute, the living room becomes a space station, and the next it turns into a jungle, a castle, or even a rescue **centre**.”

The exact meaning is:

centre = 專門集中某類活動、服務、人員或工作的一個地方 / 機構

Therefore:

> **rescue centre**

= “「救援活動和相關服務集中的救援中心」”

This is not:

* **the centre of the room** = 房間中央

* **city centre** = 市中心

* **centre of attention** = 注意力焦點

* **political centre** = 政治中間立場

* **centre the title** = 把標題置中

In the passage, **centre** belongs to the **institution/service-place sense**:

> **rescue activity** → concentrated in one place → **rescue centre**.